

HANOVER SURVEYS HELP BAKERSFIELD MEET ITS TEACHERS' PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT NEEDS



CHALLENGE

Bakersfield City School District (Bakersfield) in California wanted to determine if its professional learning offerings were meeting its teachers' needs. After pivoting from externally sourced training to a robust program of in-house learning, Bakersfield wanted to ensure that its offerings were providing the most meaningful experiences to its teachers.

SOLUTION

Bakersfield partnered with Hanover Research to gather teacher feedback on its professional learning offerings. Hanover administered and analyzed a professional learning survey that identified teachers' opinions on the training and informed the content of its summer training institute, a seasonal program that aims to energize teachers while increasing their motivation throughout the year. Then, Hanover administered a follow-up survey to assess the effectiveness of Bakersfield's summer training.

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT SURVEY ASSESSMENT

BENCHMARK TEACHER EXPECTATIONS

Hanover administered a professional learning survey to identify teachers' opinions on training to inform the summer institute.

ASSESS TRAINING EFFECTIVENESS

Hanover administered a follow-up survey to assess the effectiveness of the summer institute.

END OF
SCHOOL YEAR

SUMMER
TRAINING
INSTITUTE

START OF
SCHOOL YEAR

KEY FINDINGS

Hanover's survey assessment found that teachers would like their district to:



INCREASE CLASSROOM SUPPORT

Teachers expressed a need for a professional development approach to increased classroom support and follow-through.



REDUCE FOCUS ON BALANCED LITERACY TRAINING

Teachers wanted the district to diversify its approach to literacy training and move away from its heavy focus on guided classroom readings.



ADD SOCIAL-EMOTIONAL LEARNING FOCUS

Teachers voiced a need for in-depth training on social-emotional learning (SEL) to gain confidence in implementing SEL classroom structures.

IMPACT

- ✓ Shared the survey results with its teachers' association and board of trustees
- ✓ Provided data to the union president to determine how to best support teachers through a coaching model
- ✓ Launched conversations to affirm districts' vision for professional learning and get internal buy-in for coaching model improvements

“We want our teachers to give feedback and lead sessions, focusing on a culture of collective efficacy to support our belief system. Having a partner like Hanover Research fits a longstanding need in our district. We have been able to make the progress we've made because we have a third-party vendor...we're positioned for great success.”

—Mark Luque
Assistant Superintendent, Educational Services

For more information regarding this case study, contact info@hanoverresearch.com